

You received this email because you are registered with the email address: unsub@sastratech.com. We respect your privacy. View our [Privacy Policy](#). (If you believe this has been sent to you in error, please safely unsubscribe)

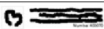


Figure 5: PHPList unsubscribe option

non-intended recipients of your bulk mail to report abuse. To do that, send an email (TXT, not HTML) to update@abuse.net. Ideally, you should list the email address that recipients will use to report abuse, and the email should look similar to the following:

sastratechologies.com: abuse@sastratechologies.com

Ensure that your contact information on WHOIS is up to date. You can do this via your domain registrar.

This apart, there are certain last minute details that you should look into before you send your first email newsletter.

For starters, make changes to the email text body, as follows.

Include a link to add the address in the address book

Your email text body should have a link telling subscribers to add the sender ID to their address book, especially on public mail servers like Gmail and Yahoo. If the sender's address is in your address book, the incoming mail is not classified as spam.

Include an explanatory message

At the bottom of the page, include a line to mention why the recipient is receiving this email. Figure 5 gives an example of a large online retailer using such a message in the footer of its bulk email.

Include a link to unsubscribe

Include a link, which when clicked on, unsubscribes the recipient from the list.

Include a 'Reply to' email ID as a form of unsubscribing

You should have an email ID to which recipients can send an email to unsubscribe. We find that most people

Blacklists

There are over a hundred blacklists. Here are a few of the most popular ones.

- **SORBS DUHL**: The Spam and Open Relay Blocking System (SORBS) provides free access to a DNS-based block list - <http://www.sorbs.net/lookup.shtml>
- **UCEPROTECTL3**: The project's mission is to stop mail abuse globally - <http://www.uceprotect.net/>
- **SPAMHAUS ZEN**: Maintains a number of security intelligence databases and real time spam blocking databases - <http://www.spamhaus.org/>
- **RATS Dyna**: Uses IP reputations to reduce bulk email - <http://www.spamrats.com/>
- **SEM BLACK**: SpamEatingMonkey.com provides real time IP and domain blacklists to prevent the delivery of unwanted mail - <http://spameatingmonkey.com/index.html>

prefer to include a link rather than an email address for unsubscribing, to avoid the email ID from being harvested (Figure 5).

Send confirmation messages to subscribers that offer a facility to unsubscribe

Periodically, send a summary mail of the newsletter subscriptions and allow the recipient to unsubscribe by clicking a link from within this email.

Have an email ID for people to report abuse

Earlier in this article we created an email ID for abuse reporting and listed it on abuse.net. So do ensure that this email ID is monitored and any reports of abuse are dealt with appropriately.

Use the precedence:bulk header field

Though some people advocate the usage of a 'precedence:bulk' field in the header of your email messages, we have seen very few organisations use it. *The Huffington Post* sets a 'precedence:bulk' in its daily briefs but several others don't.

RFC is the 'Request For Change', a mechanism by which users request for changes in programs. The RFC 2076 deals with common Internet message headers and explains in great detail the commonly occurring headers in email messages. It discourages the use of the precedence header, as many recipient servers will just filter that off.

Send your first newsletter

Now that you are set, create your first email campaign.

Ensure that you include everything mentioned above in your email, and then send it out to a close circle of friends. Enjoy the response you receive! 

References

- [1] PHPLIST: A popular open source newsletter manager - <http://www.phplist.com>
- [2] Sendmail: An industry standard MTA (Mail Transfer Agent) - <http://www.sendmail.com/>
- [3] OpenDKIM: An open source milter service for providing DKIM services - <http://www.opendkim.org/>
- [4] OpenSSL: An open source project to develop a robust, commercial grade, full-featured and open source toolkit implementing SSL - <http://www.openssl.org/>
- [5] MXToolBox: An online service for querying the DNS zone file of your domain. It gives you an indication if your DNS server changes have been propagated - <http://mxtoolbox.com>

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